FREE GUIDE · THE OP TEAM

SELLING A HOME IN VAUGHAN

The 15 steps from deciding to sell to handing over the keys, with a checklist for each one.



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STEP 1 OF 15

KNOW YOUR WHY

Your reason sets the timeline and the strategy.

Moving up, downsizing, relocating for work or settling an estate: each one changes how fast you need to sell, how you price and whether you buy or sell first.

Before you call anyone, get clear on where you are going next and when you need to be there.

- [ ] Write down why you are selling
- [ ] Pick your ideal move date and your latest possible date
- [ ] Decide where you are moving and your budget for it
- [ ] Talk to your lender about bridge financing if you might buy first

> **MICHAEL'S TIP:** Most sellers are also buyers. Plan both moves together so you are never stuck paying for two homes or racing to find one.

STEP 2 OF 15

INTERVIEW REALTORS

Compare how each agent prices, markets and negotiates.

Meet two or three agents. The right one will show you real sales near you, a written marketing plan and how they handle offers.

Ask how they will reach buyers, who shoots the photos and how often you will hear from them.

- [ ] What sold near me in the last 3 months, and for how much?
- [ ] How would you price my home, and why?
- [ ] Who does the photos, video and drone?
- [ ] Offer date or offers any time, and why?
- [ ] How often will you update me?

STEP 3 OF 15

PRICE IT RIGHT

Price from recent sales, not from what you need.

Buyers compare your home to every other listing and to what has sold nearby. Price it in line with the market and you draw the most buyers in the first two weeks, when interest is highest.

An overpriced home sits, and a home that sits starts to look like something is wrong with it.

- [ ] Review sales from the last 3 to 6 months within your neighbourhood
- [ ] Look at what is for sale now: that is your competition
- [ ] Adjust for size, lot, finishes, basement and parking
- [ ] Agree on a list price and an offer strategy together

> **MICHAEL'S TIP:** The first two weeks bring the most showings. That is when pricing matters most.

STEP 4 OF 15

KNOW YOUR NET

See what you walk away with before you list.

Your net is the sale price minus your costs. In Ontario, sellers do not pay land transfer tax; the buyer does.

Your main costs are real estate commission plus 13% HST on it, legal fees, your mortgage payout and any prepayment penalty, and moving costs.

- [ ] Get a mortgage payout statement and ask about any penalty
- [ ] Budget for repairs, staging and moving
- [ ] Get a quote from a real estate lawyer
- [ ] Run your numbers in the cost-to-sell calculator at soldmike.com

> **MICHAEL'S TIP:** Ask your lender about porting your mortgage to the next home. It can avoid a penalty.

STEP 5 OF 15

PREP YOUR HOME

Small fixes buyers notice pay for themselves.

Buyers notice the little things: a dripping tap, a scuffed wall, a burnt-out bulb. Each one makes them wonder what else was not looked after.

Fix what is easy, paint what needs it and clear out what you will not take with you.

- [ ] Fresh neutral paint where walls are marked or bold
- [ ] Declutter: clear counters, closets and shelves
- [ ] Tidy the front: lawn, garden, door and lights
- [ ] Fix taps, doors, trim, caulking and light bulbs
- [ ] Deep clean, including windows and carpets

STEP 6 OF 15

STAGE TO SELL

Help buyers picture living there.

Staging makes rooms look bigger, brighter and easier to live in, and it makes the photos work harder online.

You do not need to stage every room. Focus on the living room, kitchen and primary bedroom.

- [ ] Remove extra furniture so rooms feel open
- [ ] Add simple touches: fresh towels, plants, neutral bedding
- [ ] Put away family photos and personal items
- [ ] Consider professional staging for a vacant home

> **MICHAEL'S TIP:** An empty home looks smaller in photos. Even a few staged pieces help buyers understand the space.

STEP 7 OF 15

PROFESSIONAL MEDIA

Most buyers see your home online first.

Your photos are your first showing. Every listing with us gets professional photos, drone, video, twilight shots and a floor plan from our own production team, Toronto Property Media.

Good media brings more buyers through the door, and more buyers means more competition.

- [ ] Finish prep and staging before media day
- [ ] Hide cars, bins, cords and pet items
- [ ] Turn on every light and open the blinds
- [ ] Clear bathroom and kitchen counters completely

STEP 8 OF 15

CHOOSE YOUR STRATEGY

Offer date or offers any time.

With an offer date, buyers have about a week to see the home, then everyone sends their offer at the same time. It works best when we expect several buyers.

Taking offers any time works better when the market is slower or the home is one of a kind. We decide based on your home and the market that week.

- [ ] Look at how many similar homes are for sale
- [ ] Watch showings and interest in the first days
- [ ] Decide how you will handle an early bully offer
- [ ] Agree on your must-haves: price, closing date, conditions

STEP 9 OF 15

LAUNCH THE LISTING

Everything goes out on day one.

Your home goes live on the MLS® and REALTOR.ca, on our social media, to our buyer list and to the agent network, all at once.

The first weekend sets the tone, so we make it count.

- [ ] Coming-soon posts before the MLS® launch
- [ ] MLS® go-live with all photos and video
- [ ] Email to our buyer list and agent network
- [ ] First open house the first weekend

STEP 10 OF 15

SHOWINGS AND OPEN HOUSES

Keep it show-ready and listen to the feedback.

Showings are booked through our system, and we ask every agent for feedback afterward.

Keep the home ready with little notice: beds made, counters clear, lights on.

- [ ] Lock away valuables, medication and personal papers
- [ ] Plan where pets go during showings
- [ ] Leave during showings so buyers feel at home
- [ ] Read the feedback with us every few days

STEP 11 OF 15

REVIEW OFFERS

Look past the top number.

An offer is more than a price. The deposit, conditions, closing date and what is included all matter.

A slightly lower offer with no conditions and a strong deposit can be safer than the highest one.

- [ ] Price
- [ ] Conditions: financing, inspection, sale of their home
- [ ] Inclusions: appliances, light fixtures, window coverings
- [ ] Deposit amount
- [ ] Closing date

STEP 12 OF 15

NEGOTIATE AND ACCEPT

Sign backs until the terms work for you.

If an offer is close but not right, we sign it back with changes. Each offer has an irrevocable time: a deadline for you to respond.

As a Real Estate Negotiation Expert (RENE), Michael keeps the negotiation focused on what matters most to you.

- [ ] Know your lowest price and best closing date before offers come in
- [ ] Get everything agreed in writing
- [ ] Respond before the irrevocable time

STEP 13 OF 15

CONDITIONS COME OFF

The deal goes firm.

Most offers have conditions, such as financing or a home inspection, each with a deadline, often about five business days.

When the buyer waives or fulfils every condition, the deal is firm and the SOLD sign goes up.

- [ ] Give the inspector access when asked
- [ ] Track each condition deadline with us
- [ ] Send the firm deal to your lawyer right away

STEP 14 OF 15

LAWYER AND MORTGAGE DISCHARGE

Your lawyer handles the closing.

Your lawyer gets the payout amount from your lender, pays off your mortgage from the sale proceeds and transfers the title to the buyer.

Book your movers, and line up your utilities and insurance for the move.

- [ ] Send the firm agreement to your lawyer
- [ ] Give your lawyer your lender details
- [ ] Book movers for closing week
- [ ] Arrange to cancel or move utilities and insurance

STEP 15 OF 15

CLOSING DAY

Keys handed over, proceeds in hand.

On closing day the lawyers exchange the funds and documents and the deed registers in the buyer's name.

You leave the keys as agreed and your lawyer sends you the proceeds.

- [ ] Move out and leave the home clean
- [ ] Leave keys, garage remotes and alarm codes
- [ ] Leave appliance manuals and warranties
- [ ] Take final meter readings

> **MICHAEL'S TIP:** Congratulations. We will check in after you move to make sure everything went smoothly.

YOUR NOTES

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Michael and The OP Team have more than 2,000 transactions of combined experience, with our own media team, Toronto Property Media, behind every listing.

MICHAEL BARILLARI

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RENE Real Estate NEGOTIATION EXPERT

SRS SELLER REPRESENTATIVE SPECIALIST

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